

Learning Plan: Promo + Consulting

Alex Rivera • updated 2026-06-09 • horizon: now through Q4 2026

Everything here serves one of two career moves: the Staff Engineer promo packet (due Q4 2026) and growing the consultancy toward the \$8,000/mo full-time threshold for the 2027 decision.

Priority stack

Focus	Hrs/wk	Serves	Status
System design course	4	Staff packet (core)	60%
Eng leadership + influence	2	Staff packet (story)	25%
Reading (DDIA, Staff Eng Path)	ride-along	Both	ongoing
UX with Jordan	1	Consulting (Hopeline)	40%
Family Spanish	1	Family, steady	30%

How it maps to the promo

- System design course modules 7 to 10 finish **before** drafting the packet, so the design doc has real depth.
- Leadership course supplies the cross-org influence narrative the Staff bar requires.
- Pull one design-doc pattern from the course into an actual TechFlow doc others reuse. That artifact is the packet's anchor.

How it maps to the consultancy

- UX course (with Jordan) feeds the Hopeline nonprofit site work and sharpens client deliverables.
- Data-intensive reading backs the Acme dashboard and Bluepeak pipeline engagements.
- Client scoping and pricing is a named target skill: better scoping wins the Northwind retainer and moves MRR toward \$8,000.

Guardrails

- Protect ~4 hrs/week of system design even on heavy half-marathon training weeks (race 2026-11-15).
- Saturdays are long-run + family, no study. Mon/Wed/Fri early mornings carry the load.
- Spanish stays light, at dinner with Maya. No streak pressure.